

INTRODUCTION

The Protection Monitoring System (PMS) continues to provide timely and systematic evidence on protection risks affecting displaced populations across Gaza. Through a combination of Key Informant Interviews (KII) and Focus Group Discussions (FGD), the system captures both quantitative trends and qualitative insights to inform protection analysis and response planning. This snapshot presents an overview of protection risk severity scores, evolving risk trends since the start of monitoring in August 2024, and key protection concerns raised by affected communities during the most recent reporting period.



Methodology

During this reporting period, data collection was conducted through structured interviews with key informants representing diverse community groups and sectors, and through facilitated focus group discussions engaging displaced populations across multiple locations. A central role in data collection was played by the Emergency Protection Responders Network under the umbrella of the Protection Cluster in Gaza, whose trained field teams carried out the majority of KIIs and FGDs, ensuring timely, community-based data collection under challenging field conditions. The data collection tools applied were developed based on the Protection Analytical Framework (PAF), enabling comprehensive monitoring of protection risks aligned with Global Protection Cluster standards.

806 KII

KEY INFORMANT
INTERVIEWS

98 FGD

FOCUS GROUP
DISCUSSIONS

1786

HOUSEHOLDS
SURVEYED

9823

HOUSEHOLDS
INDIVIDUALS

Protection Risk Severity Scores

Reporting Period from 1 May - 31 May 2026

Severity scores are calculated based on weighted aggregation of prevalence, causes, affected populations, and coping mechanisms according to the PMS Risk Calculation Rulebook.

85%

Attacks on
Civilians and
other Unlawful
Killings, and
Attacks on
Civilian Objects

75%

Unlawful
Impediments or
Restrictions to
Freedom of
Movement,
Siege and Forced
Displacement

73%

Psychological/
Emotional
Abuse or
Inflicted
Distress

70%

Presence of
Explosive
Ordnance

58%

Gender-Based
Violence

46%

Child and
Forced Family
Separation

45%

Child, Early or
Forced Marriage

50%

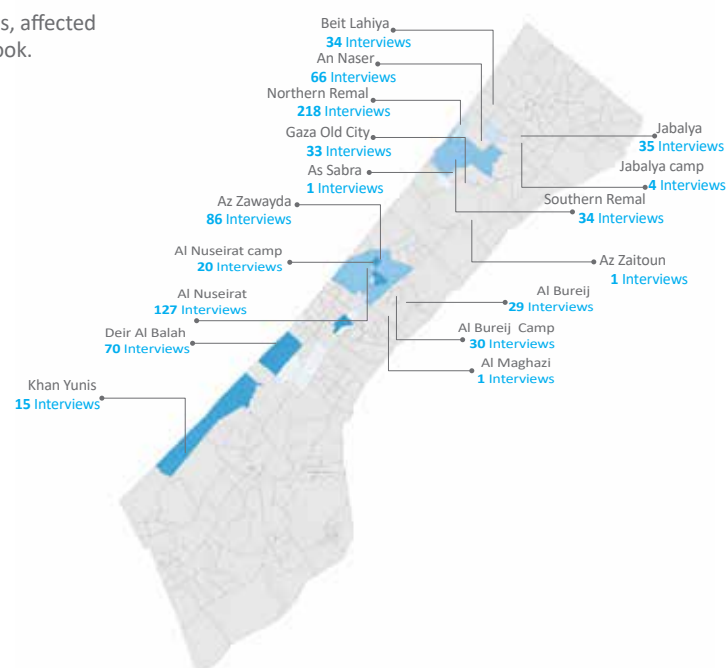
Disinformation
and Denial of
Access to
Information

40%

Theft, Extortion,
Forced Eviction
or Destruction
of Personal
Property

16%

Discrimination and
Stigmatization,
Denial of
Resources,
Opportunities,
Services and/or
Humanitarian
Access



ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

During the reporting period, the protection data collected in this report is made possible by the contributions and participation of AIAwda, FAFD, UNRWA, OHCHR, and local volunteers, whose efforts are crucial in understanding and addressing the ongoing protection risks in Gaza.

GAZA PROTECTION CLUSTER SNAPSHOT

Protection Monitoring

Reporting period from 1 May - 31 May 2026

Protection Risk Severity Scores Trends

(Aug 2024 – May 2026)

Key Informants reporting protection violations or issues over time.



Qualitative Analysis

KEY PROTECTION RISKS IDENTIFIED BY THE COMMUNITIES

- Food insecurity and reduced access to food:** Participants reported increasing difficulties in accessing food, including bread, following the suspension of community kitchens that many displaced households had relied upon as a primary source of daily meals. Continued price increases, rising debt levels due to financial hardship, and diminishing household resources were reported to further limit access to food and other basic needs.
- Limited access to safe drinking and domestic water:** Participants reported severe shortages of safe drinking water and highlighted the burden associated with collecting, transporting, and storing water for household use.
- Inadequate shelter conditions, overcrowding, and lack of privacy:** Many tents have deteriorated due to prolonged use and exposure to weather conditions. Rising temperatures further exposed these limitations, with families reporting insufficient protection from heat. Overcrowding and lack of privacy continued to negatively affect living conditions across displacement sites.
- Sanitation, Environmental Health Hazards, and Infestation:** Communities reported increasing numbers of rodents, insects, and lice within displacement sites, linked to inadequate waste management, open sewage, and uncovered wastewater pits. Deteriorating sanitation conditions, combined with rising temperatures, were perceived as increasing exposure to disease and undermining dignity and safety. Participants expressed particular concern regarding the impact on children, older persons, persons with disabilities, and individuals with pre-existing health conditions.
- Barriers to accessing humanitarian assistance and civil documentation:** Participants reported challenges related to obtaining or renewing identification documents, as well as concerns regarding the non-recognition of newly issued documents by some humanitarian actors. Difficulties associated with digital assistance delivery mechanisms, including telecommunications disruptions, loss of assistance codes, and complications linked to digital wallet systems, were also reported.
- Explosive ordnance and war remnants:** The presence of unexploded ordnance and explosive remnants of war (ERW) in and around displacement sites continued to raise protection concerns. Communities reported receiving awareness sessions; however, the proximity of hazardous items to populated areas, particularly locations frequented by children, remained a source of

concern. Limited awareness of reporting mechanisms and access to survivor assistance services may further increase protection risks for affected population

- "Yellow Line" Risks and Access Impact:** Communities located near the so-called "yellow" and "orange" lines reported significant safety and security risks, including killings and injuries attributed to Israeli military operations. These conditions have also severely hindered humanitarian partners' access to affected areas, resulting in critical gaps in service delivery for residents in these locations.

IMPACTS ON THE POPULATION

- Psychological distress and reduced sense of stability:** Participants described increasing levels of stress, anxiety, and frustration associated with the inability to meet basic household needs, prolonged displacement, and uncertainty regarding future assistance. Feelings of helplessness and concern regarding future living conditions were frequently reported.
- Health impacts and increased exposure to disease:** Poor environmental conditions, limited access to safe water, and inadequate sanitation services were reported to increase exposure to health risks, including skin diseases, insect infestations, and other hygiene-related concerns. Participants also associated rodent and insect infestations with declining health and wellbeing within displacement sites.
- Loss of dignity and deteriorating living conditions:** Overcrowding, lack of privacy, inadequate shelter conditions, and challenges accessing sufficient water for daily use were reported to negatively affect dignity and quality of life, particularly during periods of high temperatures.
- Impacts on children:** Children were described as being increasingly affected by food insecurity, limited access to nutritious food, reduced opportunities for recreation, and inadequate living conditions. Caregivers also expressed growing concerns regarding children's emotional wellbeing and overall development.
- Increased strain on vulnerable groups:** Older persons, persons with disabilities, and individuals with pre-existing health conditions were reported to face heightened challenges due to barriers in accessing services, deteriorating environmental conditions, and increased dependence on caregivers and community support.

COPING MECHANISMS

- Reduction of food consumption:** Participants reported reducing meal frequency and portion sizes in response to food shortages, rising prices, and limited financial resources. Caregivers, particularly women, were reported to frequently prioritise children and other family members when food was scarce, often reducing their own consumption. Children were also perceived as being particularly affected due to their nutritional needs
- Growing debt and credit purchases:** Households described purchasing food and other necessities on credit, accumulating debt. Food expenditures were prioritized over other essential household needs.
- Increased dependence on humanitarian assistance:** Communities reported increasing reliance on humanitarian assistance to meet basic needs, particularly following the loss of other food sources and livelihood opportunities.
- Reliance on family, neighbours, and community support:** Participants described depending on relatives, neighbours, and community members for financial assistance, food sharing, information, and practical support.
- Resource sharing and support for vulnerable households:** Families reported sharing available resources and supporting vulnerable neighbours to help address immediate needs and service gaps.
- Seeking alternative sources of water and basic supplies:** In some locations, households reported spending significant time and effort collecting water or searching for alternative sources of food and essential household items.

COMMUNITY CAPACITIES

- Communities highlighted the continued role of neighbours, extended family members, and community networks in supporting vulnerable households and helping address urgent needs. They described assisting older persons, persons with disabilities, and households facing financial, social, or mobility-related challenges through practical support and referrals. They also reported relying on informal communication channels and community networks to share information regarding available assistance, distributions, and services. Despite deteriorating conditions, communities continued to demonstrate resilience by mobilising available resources, supporting one another, and adapting collectively to service gaps and resource shortages.